

Prior Authorization Workflow Summary

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PATIENT SCENARIO

PATIENT NAME James T., 34M	PAYER Aetna HMO
PROCEDURE MRI Brain with/without Contrast	SCENARIO Diagnostic MRI
CPT CODE 70553	ICD-10 G43.909

OUTCOME & PERFORMANCE

FINAL OUTCOME Approved	DAYS ELAPSED 23 days
EFFICIENCY SCORE 84% (Grade B)	DOCUMENTS SUBMITTED 4 / 5
WORKFLOW STEPS 9 completed	WORKFLOW ACCURACY Good

WORKFLOW TIMELINE

STAGE	DAY	NOTES
Intake	Day 0	Patient intake completed. PA requirement confirmed for Aetna HMO.

STAGE	DAY	NOTES
Medical Need	Day 1	Medical necessity evaluated against payer clinical criteria.
Doc Collection	Day 3	Required documentation gathered and verified.
Submitted to Payer	Day 6	Prior authorization submitted electronically to payer.
PA Pended	Day 8	pend
Payer Review	Day 8	Payer clinical review completed by UM team.
Doc Collection	Day 18	Required documentation gathered and verified.
Submitted to Payer	Day 21	Prior authorization submitted electronically to payer.
Outcome	Day 23	Final coverage decision rendered: APPROVED.

EDUCATIONAL SUMMARY

Diagnostic imaging PAs are usually straightforward when clinical red flags are documented. "Thunderclap" headaches and neurological changes are urgent criteria that most payers honor for expedited review.